Lab 5 — Direct Shots and Takes in Cinema Studio

Topic 02 · Improve Video Footage on GAI Powered Video Platforms · Maps to: review footage to improve storytelling; solutions to rectify quality issues

Direct a 15-second bar scene the way a film crew would: attach your Elements as references with roles, set camera, lens, lighting and colour, write the shots and the sound, then render four 480p Draft takes. Finalise only the best take in 1080p.

> **You'll build:** Four Draft takes of one scene and one 1080p final of the best take, made from your Elements.
> **Tools:** Higgsfield: Cinema Studio, Seedance 2.5 / Seedance 2.5 Draft, References, Elements

Steps

1. Open Video → Cinema Studio. Click References and attach @char_biker, @char_friend, @prop_suitcase and @loc_bar-interior. One generation accepts up to 50 references: 30 images, 10 videos, 10 audio.
2. Give each reference a role: Character for the people, Location for the bar. Type @ in the prompt to insert a handle.
3. Open Film setup: choose a camera body, a lens and an aperture (f/1.4 wide open for shallow focus). Open Lighting: pick Practicals. Open Colour palette: pick Film colors. Set Genre to Drama.
4. Write the prompt in three parts (prompts page): scene context, references with '100% as shown in the reference image', then numbered shots with sizes and camera.
5. Choose the shot structure: one continuous 15-second shot, or multishot with a cut between each. Use the multishot version for this lab.
6. Add the Sound line: bar ambience, footsteps, clothing movement and the one line of dialogue.
7. Select Seedance 2.5 Draft, 480p, 21:9 or 16:9, 15 s, sound On, 4 videos. Press Generate Draft (about 45 credits per take).
8. Watch all four takes with sound. Note for each: character match, prop position, camera, audio. Pick one.
9. Open the chosen Draft and finalise it in 1080p (Seedance 2.5 renders the same take at full resolution, about 240 credits for 15 s; drafts can be finalised within 7 days).
10. Screenshot the Cinema Studio prompt panel with the references attached and the four-take grid for your evidence.

Prompts

Open **prompts.html** in this folder for one-click copy (or prompts.pdf to print).

BAR SCENE — THREE-PART PROMPT (SEEDANCE 2.5)

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Scene context: Biker enters a bar with a suitcase, looking for his friend. They notice
each other, and the biker walks over and sits next to him as he lays his case flat on
the counter.
References:
@char_biker — biker, 100% as shown in the reference image.
@char_friend — friend, 100% as shown in the reference image. He is seated on a stool on
the side of the bar counter.
@prop_suitcase — suitcase, 100% as shown in the reference image. It belongs to
@char_biker. He carries it in his left hand.
@loc_bar-interior — the bar, 100% as shown in the location reference.
Shots (cut between each):
1. 0–3s: wide, the biker pushes through the door, suitcase in his left hand.
2. 3–6s: medium shot, the friend looks up from his beer. Static camera.
3. 6–9s: close-up, the biker recognises him.
4. 9–12s: medium close-up, the biker sits; dialogue: "Told you I'd make it."
5. 12–15s: close-up, he lays the case flat on the counter.
Sound: bar ambience, footsteps, leather jacket movement, the line of dialogue.
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ONE CONTINUOUS SHOT (COMPARE)

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One continuous 15-second take. Follow a man along a busy New York sidewalk. Move from
behind him to a frontal view as he reaches the corner. Keep the action uninterrupted,
with no cuts.
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Mock assets (assets/)

- cinema-studio-cheatsheet.pdf — camera, lens, aperture, lighting, colour, genre, era, tempo
- shot-size-guide.pdf — wide, medium close-up, close-up and what each one is for
- take-log.csv — take, character match, prop, camera, audio, keep?

Evidence to keep

Screenshot these. The Practical Performance asks you to paste screenshots like them under each task.

- Cinema Studio prompt panel with your references attached
- The four Draft takes and your 1080p final

Check your work

> All four Drafts use your Elements; your take log scores each take; the 1080p final is the take you scored best and keeps the same faces, prop and bar.

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